MONTHLY UPDATE

Data Storage: monthly update, September – October 2026

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> *28 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · CAMEROON · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · EGYPT · ESWATINI · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MALAWI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · TUNISIA · UGANDA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The digitalisation commission's communique of 2 September names Blida as the second national data centre and records it obtaining Uptime Institute Tier III Design certification, the same certification Mohammadia obtained in February; installation there began in March 2025. What is certified is the design and not the constructed facility, which the commission says it is still working towards.

The same day the investment agency awarded a private e-commerce firm a land concession at El Affroun, in Blida wilaya, for a data centre it expects to create 340 jobs. No investment amount, capacity or timetable is stated.

Angola

The state printer inaugurated a data centre on 11 September with more than 170 TB of storage and full redundancy for the official gazette's records; no investment value is disclosed.

Botswana

The gas supplier's annual report said the Kala Data Centre ran materially below its design capacity in the year to June 2026 for lack of gas from the one connected well. Any expansion depends on gas availability, funding and commercial terms.

Burkina Faso

The digital-transition minister put the national data centre planned for 2028 at an estimated FCFA 20bn.

Cameroon

The Douala project was confirmed and qualified in the same week. The vendor confirmed US$75m, about FCFA 42.25bn, for a data centre designed in part for artificial-intelligence workloads with dedicated power generation, while the planning ministry described it as an intention presented at the first bilateral economic forum rather than a

commitment. The distinction is worth holding onto: the same vendor's Ivorian project is underwritten by a United States export-credit guarantee, which is the shape a commitment takes on the record, and nothing of that kind is published here.

Central African Republic

Fire damaged part of the national elections authority's data-processing centre in the week before 24 September, weeks ahead of the October residual elections. The government opened an investigation and says the vote will go ahead; no cause, damage estimate or continuity arrangement is stated.

Congo

The national data centre is not in service. On 22 September the vice-prime minister put works at 82% and operation at the end of 2026 or early 2027, with energy tests within a month, and a 12 MW solar farm is to back it because grid power alone would deter clients. The operator's own estate is a different thing.

Cote d'Ivoire

The financing behind the sovereign data centre is now on the record, and it is a fraction of the project. Opening of the state data centre is targeted for 2027 at an estimated US$66 million, specified at 1.73MW of IT capacity within 3MW of total power, 228 racks and 10 petabytes of storage.

A data centre was installed at the national polytechnic institute in Yamoussoukro to support electronic administration and the storage, processing and security of public data. No capacity, operator or cost is stated.

Egypt

On 3 September the communications minister met a US data-centre developer and the American consortium it leads to discuss an integrated hyperscale and AI zone, with no investment figure stated.

Agreements linking Vodafone Business, Cassava Technologies and Elsewedy Electric were put at up to US$1bn (15 September), with no site, capacity or date. A domestic investment holding reviewed its Kemet data centre in the Suez Canal Economic Zone with the communications minister on 23 September: an 80 MW Tier III site with USD 270 million allocated to the first phase of a project put at USD 1.2 billion. No timeline was disclosed. An investment company's chief executive put installed data-centre IT load at about 15 to 20 MW, against 400 to 500 MW announced, of which about 20 MW is committed. The state digital-finance operator signed a memorandum with a Chinese cloud provider to explore offering its services to Egyptian businesses from locally hosted infrastructure.

Eswatini

The finance minister told Parliament on 22 September that the disaster recovery site planned for Lubombo had failed to proceed, the US$10.4 million India Exim loan behind it had never been drawn, and Treasury had written to the lender asking to cancel it. He also said government needs a functional primary data centre before a backup, and that the science-park facility does not constitute a fully operational data centre. Its operator describes the same facility as Tier III.

On 24 September the science park confirmed an incident affecting the National Data Centre that disrupted at least 12 government services, with its engineers and outside experts working to restore them. It did not confirm social-media claims of a hack or a ransom demand, and had first acknowledged an outage of its web services on 18 September. The finance ministry said the loan for the disaster recovery site has not been cancelled, only the commitment fees on its undrawn balance, correcting the reading of the minister's remarks to Parliament.

Gabon

Chinese interest in state hosting became a site visit. A Chinese government delegation, following an earlier Huawei mission, inspected the postal company's and Gabon Telecom's infrastructure on 15 September with an AI data centre for public administration applications in view; the postal site has six blocks able to host more than 300 servers. No agreement, financing or timetable is on record.

Gambia

The first private data centre was inaugurated on 29 April 2026 and announced from the State House, the operator claiming it as the country's first. No capacity, occupancy or certification figure accompanies the claim, which leaves the country's private hosting estate established in existence and unmeasured in every other respect.

Ghana

The storage estate gained a number rather than a building. The communications minister put an artificial-intelligence computing centre at US$250m, beside US$200m for digitalisation, as the government's answer to capacity gaps a UNESCO readiness assessment identified. Nothing is procured, sited or dated, and no capacity figure accompanies either sum. Visiting the atomic energy commission on 9 October 2026, the science minister said its proposed AI data centre must operate under human oversight to protect sensitive nuclear information, and asked for governance arrangements to be built into the plan.

Guinea

The national data centre was found idle a year after its opening. The prime minister visited on 9 September and said the nearly US$10m facility, inaugurated in September 2025, is about 90% complete with one payment stuck and still not fully operational, calling the delay unacceptable.

The national data centre at Koloma is nearly built and not yet working. On a site visit the prime minister ordered its commissioning accelerated, the project standing at about 90 per cent executed on close to US$10m and still not fully operational. No commissioning date was set.

Kenya

One build opened rather than slipping. The operator of the largest colocation campus added 6.4MW at a second Nairobi facility on 7 September, and retired the iColo brand in Kenya and Mozambique in favour of its parent's. The figure is critical IT load rather than delivered live load, and no occupancy, customer count or campus total is published.

Two cloud platforms opened in Nairobi in September: Nobus opened an availability zone, and Tata Consultancy Services announced its sovereign cloud live on iXAfrica's campus on 28 September, delivered with the integrator Sybyl, with its capacity and pricing undisclosed. Oracle was still preparing its Nairobi region at the same campus.

Lesotho

Kobong stayed an envelope, not money. Reporting in September restated the US$6.2 billion hydropower and AI data-centre agreement with Convalt Energy as the largest foreign investment deal Lesotho has signed, with a feasibility study to run over the next year before any implementation agreement or construction. The same report found that a local firm the energy minister named as a potential partner is part-owned by the public works minister, who said he would recuse himself from cabinet discussion of the project.

Libya

A first independent assessment of a Libyan facility reached the record: a tier III design certification for the national telecom company's KM-4 site, with no capacity figures disclosed.

Malawi

The second operator reached its third data centre by purchase. It bought another company's Tier III facility at Kanengo for K12bn, about US$6.9m, to join with its Limbe site as one cloud, three months after the build it announced was due. A stop-gap expansion of the national data centre added 115 TB of storage and the redundancy link between the Lilongwe and Blantyre sites was completed in the first half of 2026.

Mauritius

The central information systems division runs a central backup service for government.

Morocco

On 8 September the Dakhla green data-centre campus was put at 100 hectares and a potential 500MW, part sovereign and part open to private investment, in a portfolio the ministry presented as taking national data-centre capacity towards one gigawatt. No cost, operator, financing close or build date is held. A British firm announced its appointment to lead design management and procurement strategy for the platform's planned 20 MW facility near Casablanca.

Namibia

The ICT minister said on 23 September that construction had begun beside the new AI institute at Kenya House. Capacity, cost and completion date are still unpublished.

Nigeria

A rating agency put a third count on the estate and named the constraint. It puts national data-centre capacity at about 197 MW, below Saudi Arabia's 435 MW, and classifies the country's power availability for data-centre development as very low, citing heavy reliance on self-generation and backup power, limited renewable transmission and chronic grid instability. The figure is on a third basis again and reconciles with neither of the two the repository already holds; what it adds is the finding that power, not demand, is what would stop the country converting artificial-intelligence interest into operating capacity.

Rwanda

The information society authority says the shared government data hub is moving into implementation, with the existing Data Sharing Platform serving in the interim; no supplier or go-live date is stated.

Senegal

The interior minister told a National Assembly committee that the government is developing national storage for civil-status, identity-card and passport data, including a data centre, after the attack on the identity-file directorate; no site, cost or date is given. A commercial operator reported expanded data-centre capacity at its site, with no capacity or cost figure.

South Africa

On 8 September a ratings agency rated South Africa's water resilience relatively low, citing water stress in Johannesburg, Gauteng and elsewhere; named energy and water as the main risks to a data-centre pipeline it puts at almost twice current global operating capacity across emerging markets; and counted more than 60 known data centres with about 500MW of disclosed capacity. It suggested operators may need modular energy supplies that bypass the main grid, and named water, not power, as the constraint that will decide growth.

In September the commission said it had received more than 250 submissions, and that the main issue was the availability, consistency and transparency of information on electricity and water demand, land use, infrastructure needs and effects on nearby communities. Civil-society groups repeated the call for construction to stop until that use has been investigated, after Cape Town approved a hyperscale facility; the city came close to running out of water in 2018. The commission has published no finding or timetable.

Equinix now puts its South African build-out at about 160MW of added capacity under a R7.5bn investment programme, having opened its Johannesburg facility in 2024, banked land in Johannesburg and Cape Town, and won planning approval in July 2026 for two Cape Town facilities expected to need about 170MW. The figures combine delivered, approved and planned capacity, and no completion date is given. In the same report the utility expects a generation surplus of 2GW–3GW over the next few years and names data centres among the demand it wants. The human rights commission's inquiry into the sector's electricity and water use continues. A hosting provider for online gaming announced its first African data centre, in Johannesburg; the site and its capacity are not disclosed. Amazon Web Services' Cape Town region, open since April 2020, carries 154 services, its own figure. The country's largest bank expanded its partnership with Huawei to move core banking systems onto a hybrid cloud, in phases across 21 African countries; no value or data-residency terms are published.

Tanzania

Zanzibar's communications minister said more than TZS 53bn is set aside for three ICT infrastructure projects, chiefly a data centre and public internet.

Tunisia

A prime ministerial circular of 2 September 2026 requires public bodies' websites and service platforms to be hosted only at the national computing centre, sectoral public centres or licensed operators, and bans circulating administrative documents over mobile applications and social media, to strengthen the security of public digital systems against cyber threats. The circular text is not held, only a newspaper account of it, and no compliance deadline, exemption route or migration plan for bodies hosted elsewhere is stated.

On 29 September the health minister named a Tunisian sovereign cloud as the host for every citizen's health identifier and digital medical record. No operator, provider or amount is named. An operator and an IT services firm announced a partnership for cloud resources hosted and operated in Tunisia; no capacity is stated.

Uganda

A former head of the communications regulator wrote that the information technology authority's strategic plan provides for a third national data centre, with a primary site at Entebbe and disaster recovery at Jinja, guided by a market study launched in 2025. The centre had been removed from the World Bank project in 2025, and no financing or timetable is stated.

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